

available on a lending app he swears by. He has taken the loan every month since early 2022. "With no increment in the past two years, and rising expenses, I find my savings gone before the end of the month. I don't wish to ask my parents for money," he says justifying his dependence on a payday loan. Payday loans are meant for the working class who have difficulty in making ends meet, and are often broke at the end of the month.

There are many youngsters like Shetty, who find it difficult to manage their finances on their own, which makes them borrow for essentials. The easy availability of loan for almost all kinds of things has made many of them forget the concept of savings and budgeting.

SIMPLE HABITS CAN MAKE A BIG DIFFERENCE IN YOUR PROGRESS TOWARD PAYING OFF DEBT. MAKE A BUDGET AND STICK TO IT

They live pay cheque-to-pay cheque, servicing EMIs (equated monthly instalments). Many youngsters believe in the power of easy credit to be a boon that makes them realise their financial goals and aspirations in a short time. The great Indian festive season on mobile apps and stores marking prices of products with EMIs instead of MRP is an indicator of where things are headed.

MANY SHADES OF DEBT

A strategic use of debt may help you achieve your short- and long-term financial goals. Sometimes, the smart move is to borrow in order to achieve your goals ahead of the time it would otherwise take to save for it. Setting aside Rs 3,000 every month for a year and then buying the